

difference between a Buick and a Ferrari. When you recognize the difference, you can critique advice properly and assign it to its correct Fastlane or Slowlane box.

MILLIONAIRES ARE RICH . . . OR ARE THEY?

I recently read an article about a young woman named Callie from the U.K. who, several years ago, won millions in a lottery, only to lose most of it shortly thereafter. Of course, “lose” implies that the entire bag of cash flew out of the car while cruising down the boulevard in her brand new convertible.

She didn’t “lose” it—*she spent it*. She was just 16 years old when she won the \$3 million, and it took only six years for her to blow it: drugs, partying, exotic cars, breast implants, and a jaw-dropping \$730,000 in designer clothes. The problem? *Callie thought she was rich* and spent like she was rich. Surely she bought into her title: “I’m a millionaire.” While \$3 million is a decent chunk of change, she needed \$30 million for her lifestyle.

Which brings us to our famous word, “millionaire.” When you hear that word, what do you think? Like wealth, you probably have visions of an extravagant lifestyle: boats, helicopters, mansions, and expensive jewelry. For decades, the term “millionaire” has been ubiquitously used to describe someone “rich.”

Except these visions of opulence describe a lifestyle of a millionaire elevated by the Fastlane, not the Slowlane. Slowlane millionaires who don’t escape by fame or corporate bastardization *live differently*. They own homes in innocuous middle-class neighborhoods. They drive unassuming cars like Hondas or Toyotas, they vacation infrequently, they limit their dining expenses, they cut coupons, and they max out their 401Ks. They work five days a week at jobs they most likely hate and diligently save 10% of their paychecks. Others own small businesses, franchises, and retail stores. Several national best-selling books have enlightened us: Yes, these are the “millionaires next door.”

Sadly, in today’s terms, a “millionaire” (net worth of \$1,000,000) is simply upper middle class. *A millionaire is not rich*. Five million is the old one million. Depressing, I know.

This hidden truth is why many lottery winners go broke after a few years. Winners envision the lavish lifestyle and live it not knowing that several million dollars won’t support it! If you win a million bucks (which after taxes is only \$600,000), your lifestyle shouldn’t change. If you try to live the “millionaire lifestyle” as shown on television, a fool and his money are soon parted.

Playing the lottery is a symptom of the Sidewalk. So why would it shock anyone to discover that a newly crowned lottery winner goes broke just years later? Lottery winners assign “rich” to the word “millionaire,” so their fortune is fast spent on the icons of wealth, and soon thereafter, they’re bankrupt. The word “millionaire” fooled them. Millionaire is middle class. To live a lifestyle normally reserved for “millionaires,” you will have to amass far more than \$1 million. Having \$1 million